

THEFT - RETAIL PREMISES

CRIME REF	25-11-0302	REPORTED	08:36 SAT 15 NOV	OFFENCE	THEFT FROM A SHOP
PREMISES	HOLLIS & DAUGHTER	ADDRESS	14 QUAY STREET	OFFICER	DC S. NAIRN

PROPERTY STOLEN

One gold open-face pocket watch, "the Tennant watch". Engraved inside the case back J.T. 1911. Held by the shop on consignment for the owner, Mr Alasdair Tennant, for sale at an asking price of **\$4,800**.

REPORT

At 08:34 on Saturday 15 November the owner, Mrs Margaret HOLLIS, opened the display safe to set out the morning trays. The velvet tray that holds the Tennant watch was in its place on the top shelf of the safe. The watch was not on it. She telephoned police at 08:36.

There is no sign of forced entry to the shop, the workshop or the safe. The shop alarm was set when Mrs Hollis arrived and she disarmed it with her own code.

The shop alarm keypad records which staff code is used. Its log shows that the alarm was **unset at 22:14 on Friday night with the code belonging to the apprentice, Theo LARK**, and set again five minutes later. Mr Lark accepts that he went back to the shop. He says he went only to collect his phone charger from the workshop.

INVESTIGATING OFFICER'S SUMMARY

Mr Lark is the only person known to have entered the premises between closing on Friday and opening on Saturday. He had the opportunity. He is 19, he is paid an apprentice's wage, and he gave no satisfactory reason why a phone charger could not wait until Monday.

The watch has not been recovered and there is no direct evidence connecting Mr Lark to it. **Insufficient evidence to charge. No further action.** Suspect: LARK, Theo.

Filed. Complaint received from the consignor, Mr Tennant, on 24 November: he does not accept that the matter was properly investigated. Referred to the Case Review Unit.

P. DESAI - SALES ASSISTANT

INTERVIEWEE	DESAI, P. (27)	DATE	15 NOV	COMMENCED	11:20
STATUS	WITNESS	INTERVIEWING	DC S. NAIRN	SHIFT, FRIDAY	12:00 - 18:00 (CLOSE)

- TRANSCRIPT BEGINS 11:20 -

DC N You were closing on Friday. Talk me through the afternoon.

PD It was quiet. Theo went off to college at four. Mrs Hollis left at half five for the dentist, so it was just me for the last half hour.

DC N When did you last see the Tennant watch?

PD Mr Voss came in at twenty to five to look at it. He'd booked. I took the tray out of the safe for him, he had a good long look, and he handed it back about five to five. He didn't buy it.

DC N And then?

PD I put the watch straight back in the safe and closed it, the minute he left. I always do. You don't leave the safe standing open in a shop.

DC N So the safe was shut from five to five.

PD Yes. I didn't open it again. Then I cashed up, set the alarm at five past six and went home.

DC N Who knows the safe code?

PD Me and Mrs Hollis. Theo doesn't have one. He's not allowed on the front counter on his own yet.

DC N Theo came back on Friday night. Did you know he was going to?

PD No. I heard this morning. I don't want to say anything against him.

[Pause.]

PD He has been short of money. Everyone knows that.

- TRANSCRIPT ENDS 11:34 -

T. LARK - APPRENTICE WATCHMAKER

INTERVIEWEE	LARK, T. (19)	DATE	15 NOV	COMMENCED	13:05
STATUS	VOLUNTARY - UNDER CAUTION	INTERVIEWING	DC S. NAIRN	SHIFT, FRIDAY	08:30 - 16:00

- TRANSCRIPT BEGINS 13:05 -

DC N The alarm log says your code opened the shop at quarter past ten on Friday night.

TL Yeah. That was me. I left my charger in the workshop. My phone was on four per cent and I had an early start on Saturday.

DC N How long were you inside?

TL Five minutes? I went straight through to the workshop at the back, got the charger off my bench, came out, set the alarm. I didn't even put the shop lights on.

DC N Did you go near the display safe?

TL No. I can't open it anyway. I've got an alarm code so I can open up for deliveries. I haven't got a safe code. Mrs Hollis says I get one when I've done a year.

DC N You're behind on your rent, I understand.

TL A bit. That's not a secret. It doesn't mean I nicked a watch.

DC N Did anyone see you?

TL There's a camera on the chemist's across the road. Look at that. I was in and out with a charger in my hand.

- TRANSCRIPT ENDS 13:16 -

M. HOLLIS - OWNER

INTERVIEWEE	HOLLIS, M. (61)	DATE	15 NOV	COMMENCED	09:40
STATUS	WITNESS - COMPLAINANT	INTERVIEWING	DC S. NAIRN	SHIFT, FRIDAY	08:30 - 17:30

- TRANSCRIPT BEGINS 09:40 -

DC N When did you last see the watch yourself?

MH Friday lunchtime. I polished the case back and put it back on its tray. Priya had a viewing booked for it in the afternoon.

DC N And you left before closing.

MH At half past five. I had the dentist at quarter to six, on Mill Lane. Priya closes on a Friday, she's done it for two years.

DC N Tell me about this morning.

MH I turned off the alarm, opened the safe for the trays, and the Tennant tray was sitting there with nothing on it. I rang you straight away. I didn't touch anything else.

DC N Is the watch insured?

MH I'd have to check the policy. It isn't mine, that's the awful part. It's Mr Tennant's. His grandfather's.

DC N Is there a camera in the shop?

MH There's one over the counter. It records onto the box in the back office. I've never known how to get anything off it.

- TRANSCRIPT ENDS 09:52 -

SHOP SYSTEMS EXTRACT

Friday 14 November 12:00 to Saturday 15 November 09:00. Printed from the alarm panel and the safe's own audit memory.

1 · ALARM KEYPAD LOG

TIMESTAMP	EVENT	CODE
14 NOV 18:05:22	SET	02 DESAI
14 NOV 22:14:05	UNSET	03 LARK
14 NOV 22:19:30	SET	03 LARK
15 NOV 08:31:48	UNSET	01 HOLLIS

2 · DISPLAY SAFE AUDIT LOG

TIMESTAMP	EVENT	CODE
14 NOV 12:48:10	OPEN	01 HOLLIS
14 NOV 12:55:02	CLOSE	01 HOLLIS
14 NOV 16:38:12	OPEN	02 DESAI
14 NOV 17:57:40	CLOSE	02 DESAI
15 NOV 08:34:10	OPEN	01 HOLLIS

The safe records every open and every close with the code used. It cannot be opened without a code. No other events are held in its memory for this period.

3 · STAFF CODES

CODE	HOLDER	ALARM	SAFE
01	M. HOLLIS, owner	YES	YES
02	P. DESAI, sales assistant	YES	YES
03	T. LARK, apprentice	YES	NO

4 · APPOINTMENT DIARY, FRIDAY

TIME	ENTRY
16:40	Viewing - Tennant pocket watch - Mr R. VOSS (booked by phone). Handled by P.D.

5 · HELD ON SITE, NOT SUPPLIED

Counter camera. A single camera over the front counter records to a video box in the back office. Footage is kept for 14 days. It was not reviewed by the investigating officer.

RECORDS & EXHIBITS

E-1.1 · STAFF ROTA, FRIDAY 14 NOVEMBER

STAFF	ON	OFF	NOTE
M. HOLLIS	08:30	17:30	Left early: dental appointment, Mill Lane, 17:45
P. DESAI	12:00	18:00	Closing
T. LARK	08:30	16:00	College, Friday afternoons

From 17:30 until closing, one member of staff was in the shop.

E-1.2 · EXHIBITS RECOVERED

REF	ITEM	LOCATION FOUND
EX-01	Velvet display tray, single watch well, empty	Display safe, top shelf
EX-02	Consignment receipt, Tennant watch, signed M. Hollis and A. Tennant	Back office file
EX-03	Workshop apron, T. Lark, charger lead missing from bench socket	Workshop, bench 2

E-1.3 · ITEM SOUGHT, NOT RECOVERED

The Tennant watch: gold, open face, engraved J.T. 1911 inside the case back. Not in the safe, the shop, the workshop, the back office, or Mr Lark's lodgings, which he allowed officers to search on 15 November.